Phishing Awareness Training

Recognize it. Resist it. Report it.



What is Phishing?

Phishing is a cyber attack where criminals pretend to be a trusted person or brand to trick you into giving away passwords, OTPs, card details, or installing malware.

Goal: steal credentials, money, or data.

74%

of breaches involve a human element, such as phishing or errors

Source: Verizon DBIR 2023

1 Bait

A fake email, SMS or call lands

2 Hook

You click, reply or share

3 Steal

Accounts, money and data are lost

Types of Phishing



Email Phishing

Mass fake emails posing as banks, shops or services.



Spear Phishing

Targeted email using your name, job or colleagues' details.



Smishing

Fake SMS with a scary message and a short link.



Vishing

Phone call from a fake bank or tech support asking for an OTP.



Whaling

Aimed at CEOs and senior staff to approve big payments.



Clone Phishing

A real email copied, with the link swapped for a malicious one.

Spot the Phishing Email

1. **From:** security@paypa1-support.com
2. **Subject:** URGENT!! Acount suspended
3. Dear Customer,
4. Your account will be closed in 24 hours. Verify now to avoid permanent loss.
5. **Verify My Account**
6. **Attachment:** invoice_2026.exe

1. **Fake sender**
   paypa1 is not paypal
2. **Spelling errors**
   "Acount", odd grammar
3. **Generic greeting**
   No real name used
4. **Urgency and threats**
   "Closed in 24 hours"
5. **Suspicious link**
   Hover to see the real URL
6. **Unexpected attachment**
   .exe, .zip, .docm files

Spot the Fake Website

LEGIT

https://www.paypal.com/signin

Exact brand domain, ends right after .com

FAKE

http://paypa1-secure-login.com

Number 1 instead of l, extra words, wrong domain

Lookalike domain

paypa1.com, amaz0n.in, or extra words like -secure-login.

HTTPS isn't proof

Fake sites can use HTTPS too. Check the domain, not the lock.

Asks for too much

A login page asking for card PIN, OTP or Aadhaar.

Sloppy design

Blurry logos, odd layout, pop-ups and typos.

Social Engineering Tactics



Urgency

"Act now or your account is blocked in 1 hour!"



Fear

"Suspicious login detected. Your data is at risk."



Authority

"This is your CEO. Transfer the payment today."



Curiosity

"See who viewed your profile" or "Leaked salary list".



Pretexting

"I'm from IT. I need your password to fix your laptop."



Baiting

"Free movie download" or a USB drive left in the car park.

Real-World Attacks

2013-15

Google and Facebook invoice scam

Fake invoices from a spoofed vendor tricked both firms into paying over $100 million.

Lesson: Verify payment changes by phone.

2016

Podesta email hack

A fake "Google security alert" made a campaign chairman enter his password. Emails were leaked.

Lesson: Never log in through email links.

2020

Twitter account takeover

Hackers phoned employees posing as IT support and hijacked famous accounts.

Lesson: Verify callers. Use security keys.

Best Practices



Think before you click

Hover over links to preview the real URL.



Verify directly

Call the official number, not the one in the message.



Turn on 2FA

Use an authenticator app or a security key.



Use a password manager

One strong, unique password per account.



Never share OTP or PIN

No real bank or company will ever ask.



Report and update

Report phishing and keep software updated.

Clicked? Do This Now

1

Stop

Close the page. Don't enter more details. Disconnect if you opened a file.

2

Secure

Change your password on the real site and turn on 2FA.

3

Alert

Call your bank to block cards. Tell your IT team.

4

Report

Report at cybercrime.gov.in or call 1930 in India.

Act fast, and don't be embarrassed. Quick reporting limits the damage.

Quiz: Question 1 of 6

An email from security@paypa1-support.com says: "Account closes in 24 hours. Click to verify!" What is the biggest red flag?

A. It mentions PayPal

B. Lookalike domain plus urgent threat

C. It arrived in the morning

D. It contains a link

Quiz: Question 2 of 6

SMS: "Your parcel is on hold. Pay ₹30 fee: bit.ly/x7Kd2". This attack is called…

- **A** Vishing
- **B** Smishing
- **C** Whaling
- **D** Clone phishing

Quiz: Question 3 of 6

Which one is the genuine Amazon India website?

A amazon.in.account-verify.com

B www.amazon.in

C amazon-support-login.net

D www.arnazon.in

Quiz: Question 4 of 6

A caller claims to be from your bank and asks for your OTP "to cancel a fraud transaction". You should…

A. Share the OTP quickly

B. Share only half of the OTP

C. Hang up and call the bank's official number

D. Ask him to email you

Quiz: Question 5 of 6

"This is your CEO. I'm in a meeting. Buy gift cards now and send me the codes." Which tactics are used?

- **A** Authority and urgency
- **B** Curiosity and baiting
- **C** Reward and trust
- **D** Reciprocity

Quiz: Question 6 of 6

You entered your password on a suspicious page. What is the FIRST thing to do?

A. Ignore it

B. Change the password on the real site, enable 2FA, report

C. Restart the laptop

D. Wait and see

Quiz Answers

B

Q1

Fake paypa1 domain plus a 24-hour threat.

B

Q2

Smishing is phishing by SMS. Avoid short links.

B

Q3

The others use lookalike or extended domains.

C

Q4

Banks never ask for OTPs. Hang up, call back.

A

Q5

Boss impersonation (authority) plus pressure.

B

Q6

Act fast: reset, turn on 2FA, report.

Stop. Think. Verify.



Pause before you click. Verify through official channels. Report anything suspicious.

India cybercrime helpline: 1930 | cybercrime.gov.in